

Korea Internet

Naver Corporation

Rating

Outperform

Price Target

035420.KS

330,000 KRW



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Quick Take: Naver - When the supplier becomes the shareholder; NVIDIA takes a stake in Naver

NVIDIA to take c.5% stake in Naver via USD1bn share issuance. Naver disclosed on July 27, 2026, before the market open, that its board approved a third-party share issuance to NVIDIA (covered by Stacy A. Rasgon): 7.2M common shares at KRW 204,500 each, raising c.KRW 1.5 trillion (USD 1.0bn). This would give NVIDIA roughly a c.5% stake in Naver's post-issuance shares, making it one of Naver's largest strategic shareholders, though the final stake may shift slightly once the share count is fixed near the payment date. ([Link](#))

A supplier, a partner, and now a shareholder. NVIDIA becoming a Naver shareholder is strategic validation of Naver's AI Factory ambitions, not a simple financial investment. The significance lies not in the equity stake itself, but in the alignment of incentives across the AI stack. A chip vendor that owns part of the platform has a stronger reason to secure supply, support infrastructure deployment, and help attract ecosystem partners. On July 24th, NAVER, NVIDIA and Brookfield plan to invest in gigawatt-scale, multi-tenant AI cloud infrastructure to power the next generation of AI companies in Korea and the U.S. ([Link](#))

This confirms our neocloud thesis. We have argued that Naver's AI Factory is unlikely to be funded solely on Naver's balance sheet. (Please see [Naver: What's \\$50bn between friends? Thoughts on neocloud funding, strategy](#)) Rather, the model increasingly resembles a partnership-driven neocloud structure, where infrastructure investors provide capital, chip vendors support compute deployment, and model providers contribute intelligence, with Naver sitting in the middle as orchestrator of the stack. NVIDIA's equity investment moves this thesis from concept to execution.

More importantly, this should improve funding credibility. The biggest investor debate around Naver's AI Factory has been execution and financing, not strategy. NVIDIA as a strategic shareholder should reduce perceived risk around demand visibility, hardware procurement, and long-term ecosystem support. This should make future SPV financing and external capital raising easier, particularly as Naver pursues a long-term ambition that could require tens of billions of dollars of infrastructure investment.

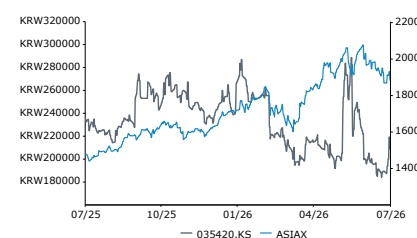
Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E
035420.KS (KRW)	13,065	14,068	15,783

Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR
Reported EPS	13,065	14,068	15,783	9.9%
Net Earnings (M)	1,953*	2,105*	2,361*	9.9%
Operating Earnings (M)	2,208*	2,239*	2,613*	8.8%
Revenues (M)	12,035*	13,530*	15,519*	13.6%

*Values shown in billions; Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Close Date	24 Jul 2026			
035420.KS Close Price (KRW)	209,500			
Price Target (KRW)	330,000			
Upside/(Downside)	58%			
52-Week Range	308,500/181,100			
ASIAX	1,880.30			
FYE	Dec			
Div Yield	1.3%			
Market Cap (KRW) (B)	32,879.82			
EV (KRW) (B)	30,256.65			
Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	(14.0)	4.5	(21.2)	(10.7)
ASIAX (%)	15.0	(4.2)	7.8	27.2
Relative (%)	(28.9)	8.7	(29.0)	(37.8)
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.				

Price Performance, 1YR



Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
Adjusted P/E (x)	16.0	14.9	13.3
EV/EBIT (x)	13.7	13.5	11.6
EV/Sales (x)	2.5	2.2	1.9

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AI infrastructure is increasingly becoming a team sport. With a global chip supplier now taking an equity stake, Naver's AI Factory is evolving beyond a customer-vendor relationship into a shared ecosystem where capital, compute, and demand are becoming more tightly aligned. That is likely more important than the investment amount itself.

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

We have **Outperform** rating on **Naver**.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

24 Jul 2026						TTM	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
			Closing	Price	Rel.								
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Price	Target	Perf.		Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
035420.KS (Naver)	O	KRW	209,500	330,000	(37.8)%		KRW	13,065	14,068	15,783	16.0	14.9	13.3
ASIAAX			1,880.30										

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY**Naver Corporation**

We have valued Naver at a price target of KRW 330,000 based on a DCF valuation method, implying one year forward PER of 20x (Q2 2027-Q1 2028). (DCF assumptions: WACC=12%, Terminal growth rate: 2%; Risk-Free Rate of Return (Rf) = 3.6%, Market Risk Premium (Rm - Rf) = 17%, Beta = 0.5).

RISKS**Naver Corporation**

Downside risk: Weaker-than-expected e-commerce GMV growth; faster-than-expected user engagement decline in the traditional search domain; government disapproval of the stock swap with Dunamu; Utilization shortfall of AI datacentre.

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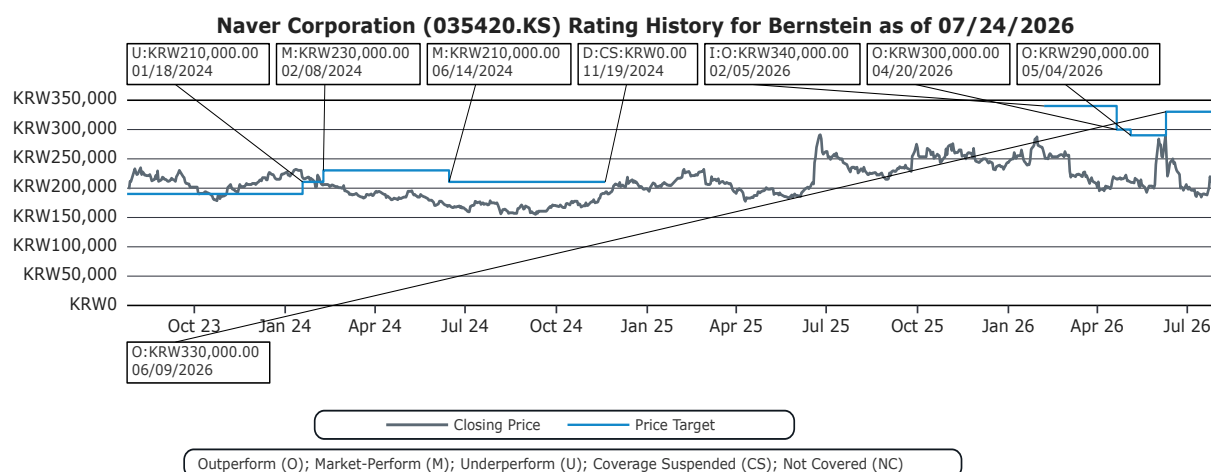
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Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.8%	16.2%
Underperform	SELL	13.1%	13.6%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.
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